

STAGE SEVEN • HARD SKILLS

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Twelve sub-sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 90 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Seven • Hard Skills

OVERVIEW

Stage Seven is by far the largest stage in the program — ninety FIRSTS, roughly five times Stage One's count. Running this stage as six single sessions, one per section, is not realistic: several sections alone would take four or more hours. This Session Plan instead splits each of the six sections into two sub-sessions (A and B), except Section 3, the largest, which splits into three (A, B, and C) — producing thirteen total sub-sessions of roughly 90-110 minutes each.

This is a genuine structural difference from every other stage's Session Plan, not a cosmetic one. If your program runs weekly meetings, expect Stage Seven to span roughly thirteen weeks rather than the more typical three to six. Cohorts with more session time available (a multi-day intensive, for instance) can combine A and B (or A, B, and C) sub-sessions into a single longer sitting with a substantial break in between.

Given the volume, this plan assumes participants are working with real, ongoing artifacts across sub-sessions — a real dataset, a real project, a real portfolio — rather than a fresh unconnected example for each FIRST. Encourage this explicitly; it both saves setup time and produces a more coherent body of work by the stage's end.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
1A / 1B	Data & Analysis — 15 FIRSTS	~100 min each
2A / 2B	Documents & Written Communication — 13 FIRSTS	~95 min each
3A / 3B / 3C	Planning & Project Management — 18 FIRSTS	~95 min each (3 sub-sessions)
4A / 4B	Visual & Presentation Tools — 14 FIRSTS	~100 min each
5A / 5B	Digital Tools & Systems — 14 FIRSTS	~100 min each
6A / 6B	Collaboration & Reflection — 16 FIRSTS	~100 min each

Total: 13 sub-sessions across roughly 1,250 minutes (about 21 hours) of facilitated time, before independent practice periods (K52's time-tracking, K80's ongoing journal, etc.) that continue between sessions.

SECTION 1

Data & Analysis

Pre-work: bring or identify one real, messy dataset (school project, work, or a public dataset) to use across both sub-sessions.

Sub-Session 1A — First Half

Covers: K1, K2, K9, K10, K26, K43, K45

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: data skills as an entry-level bottleneck	Full group
0:10–0:30	K1 Spreadsheet Mastery	Solo
0:30–0:45	K2 Data Analysis Exercise	Solo
0:45–1:05	K9 Survey/Questionnaire Designed	Solo
1:05–1:10	Short break	—
1:10–1:30	K10 Statistical Insight Extracted	Solo
1:30–1:45	K26 KPI/Metric Measurement	Solo
1:45–2:05	K43 Data Entry Accuracy Exercise + K45 Benchmarking Exercise	Solo

- Introduce the real dataset participants will use for the rest of this section right at the start of 1A.

Sub-Session 1B — Second Half

Covers: K46, K53, K62, K64, K65, K73, K81, K84

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome back + recap of 1A	Full group
0:10–0:30	K46 Analytical Problem Solved	Solo
0:30–0:50	K53 Data Cleaning Exercise	Solo
0:50–1:10	K62 Collaborative Spreadsheet	Pairs or small groups
1:10–1:15	Short break	—
1:15–1:30	K64 Survey Analysis Conducted	Solo
1:30–1:45	K65 Data Trend Interpretation	Solo
1:45–2:05	K73 Data Interpretation Report	Solo
2:05–2:20	K81 Performance Metric Tracked + K84 Critical Thinking + close	Solo, then close

- K81 launches ongoing tracking that continues after this sub-session — flag this explicitly at close.

SECTION 2

Documents & Written Communication

Pre-work: identify a real topic or project participants can write about across both sub-sessions.

Sub-Session 2A — First Half

Covers: K4, K8, K13, K16, K18, K33

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: writing as a transferable hard skill	Full group
0:10–0:35	K4 Report Written (outline)	Solo
0:35–0:55	K8 Research Summary	Solo
0:55–1:15	K13 Standard Operating Procedure Drafted	Solo
1:15–1:20	Short break	—
1:20–1:35	K16 Written Executive Summary	Solo
1:35–1:50	K18 Document Formatting Exercise	Solo
1:50–2:05	K33 Online Research Exercise + close	Solo

Sub-Session 2B — Second Half

Covers: K36, K42, K44, K58, K63, K67, K72

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome back + recap of 2A	Full group
0:10–0:30	K36 Technical Template Created	Solo
0:30–0:55	K42 Research Presentation	Solo, then pairs practice aloud
0:55–1:15	K44 Technical Summary Written	Solo
1:15–1:20	Short break	—
1:20–1:40	K58 Documentation for Others Created	Solo
1:40–2:05	K63 Mock Proposal Submission	Solo
2:05–2:20	K67 Process Documentation for Team + K72 Research Question Formulated + close	Solo, then close

SECTION 3

Planning & Project Management

The largest section in the stage (18 FIRSTS) — split into three sub-sessions rather than two. Pre-work: identify one real, moderately complex project to plan and, eventually, execute across all three sub-sessions.

Sub-Session 3A — Planning Foundations

Covers: K5, K6, K7, K11, K12, K23

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: planning as risk reduction, not bureaucracy	Full group
0:10–0:30	K5 Project Plan Drafted	Solo
0:30–0:45	K6 Meeting Agenda Prepared	Solo
0:45–1:05	K7 Budget/Expense Sheet Prepared	Solo
1:05–1:10	Short break	—
1:10–1:25	K11 Task Prioritization Exercise	Solo
1:25–1:45	K12 Risk Assessment	Solo
1:45–2:00	K23 Project Tracking Log Maintained + close	Solo, ongoing after

Sub-Session 3B — Execution Skills

Covers: K27, K37, K38, K50, K57, K66

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome back + recap	Full group
0:10–0:30	K27 Process Improvement Proposal	Solo
0:30–1:00	K37 Mini Project Completed (launch, continues after session)	Solo
1:00–1:15	K38 Problem-Solving Checklist	Solo
1:15–1:20	Short break	—
1:20–1:35	K50 Practical Application of Hard Skill	Solo
1:35–1:50	K57 Workflow Optimization Exercise	Solo
1:50–2:00	K66 Workflow Checklist + close	Solo

Sub-Session 3C — Full Execution & Closure

Covers: K70, K71, K74, K83, K88, K89

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome back + recap	Full group
0:10-0:35	K70 Multi-Step Project Plan Executed	Solo
0:35-0:55	K71 Cost/Time Estimate Prepared	Solo
0:55-1:15	K74 Task Delegation Exercise	Solo or pairs
1:15-1:20	Short break	—
1:20-1:40	K83 Simulation of Workplace Task	Solo
1:40-1:55	K88 Problem Prioritization Exercise	Solo
1:55-2:15	K89 Project Closure Documented + section close	Solo, then full-group close

- This is the natural point to have participants formally close out K37's mini project if it's still open.

SECTION 4

Visual & Presentation Tools

Pre-work: bring a phone or recording device for K34; bring or begin an online portfolio if one doesn't already exist.

Sub-Session 4A — First Half

Covers: K3, K17, K31, K32, K34, K35

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome + framing: visuals as clarity tools, not decoration	Full group
0:10-0:35	K3 Presentation Deck Created	Solo
0:35-0:50	K17 Visual Communication Created	Solo
0:50-1:10	K31 Data Visualization	Solo
1:10-1:15	Short break	—
1:15-1:35	K32 Workflow Diagram Created	Solo
1:35-2:00	K34 Digital Presentation Recording	Solo, phones needed
2:00-2:15	K35 Infographic Designed + close	Solo

Sub-Session 4B — Second Half

Covers: K39, K51, K59, K69, K75, K79, K87, K90

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome back + recap	Full group
0:10-0:25	K39 Mind Map Created	Solo
0:25-0:50	K51 Technical Presentation to Non-Experts	Solo, then pairs practice aloud
0:50-1:10	K59 Digital Portfolio Item Created	Solo
1:10-1:15	Short break	—
1:15-1:30	K69 Digital Presentation Feedback Received	Pairs
1:30-1:50	K75 Visual Project Timeline Created	Solo
1:50-2:05	K79 Online Portfolio Update	Solo
2:05-2:25	K87 Digital Presentation Shared Online + K90 Technical Showcase Event Participation + close	Solo, then discuss real showcase opportunities

- K90 is genuinely event-dependent — use this closing block to identify a real, upcoming showcase opportunity participants can commit to attending, rather than simulating it.

SECTION 5

Digital Tools & Systems

Pre-work: bring a laptop with access to at least one collaboration tool and one automation-capable tool (e.g., Zapier, or built-in automation in Sheets/Excel).

Sub-Session 5A — First Half

Covers: K14, K15, K20, K28, K40, K41

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome + framing: tool fluency as friction removal	Full group
0:10-0:30	K14 Digital Collaboration Tool Used	Solo, laptops needed
0:30-0:45	K15 Calendar/Time Management System	Solo
0:45-1:10	K20 Basic Coding or Logic Exercise	Solo
1:10-1:15	Short break	—
1:15-1:35	K28 Professional Tool Exploration	Solo
1:35-1:55	K40 Resource Library Organized	Solo
1:55-2:15	K41 File Management System Set Up + close	Solo

Sub-Session 5B — Second Half

Covers: K47, K48, K52, K54, K61, K68, K76, K82

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome back + recap	Full group
0:10-0:35	K47 Task Automation Attempted	Solo, laptops needed
0:35-0:55	K48 Cross-Platform Tool Integration	Solo
0:55-1:10	K52 Time-Tracking System Used (launch)	Solo, ongoing after
1:10-1:15	Short break	—
1:15-1:35	K54 Technical Troubleshooting Exercise	Solo
1:35-1:50	K61 Online Tool Certification Attempted (identify one)	Solo
1:50-2:05	K68 Online Form/Template Created	Solo
2:05-2:25	K76 Technical Resource Curation + K82 Multi-Tool Project Completed + close	Solo, then close

SECTION 6

Collaboration & Reflection

The closing section of the entire stage. Pre-work: gather all worksheets and reflections completed across Sections 1–5 — several FIRSTS here ask participants to look back across everything already done.

Sub-Session 6A — First Half

Covers: K19, K21, K22, K24, K25, K29, K30, K49

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: this section closes the loop on the entire stage	Full group
0:10–0:30	K19 Peer Review Participation	Pairs
0:30–0:50	K21 Public Speaking Practice	Solo, then small group
0:50–1:10	K22 Negotiation Exercise	Pairs, role-play
1:10–1:15	Short break	—
1:15–1:35	K24 Creative Brainstorming Session	Small groups
1:35–1:55	K25 Cross-Functional Collaboration	Solo or pairs
1:55–2:15	K29 Feedback Integration + K30 Hard Skill Reflection	Solo
2:15–2:25	K49 Reflection on Hard Skill Growth + close	Solo, reviewing prior reflections

Sub-Session 6B — Second Half (Stage Close)

Covers: K55, K56, K60, K77, K78, K80, K85, K86

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome back + framing: final sub-session of the largest stage in the program	Full group
0:10–0:30	K55 Collaborative Project Submission	Small groups
0:30–0:50	K56 Self-Assessment of Technical Skills	Solo
0:50–1:10	K60 Hard Skill Development Plan	Solo
1:10–1:15	Short break	—
1:15–1:35	K77 Peer Teaching Session	Pairs
1:35–1:50	K78 Reflection on Tool Efficiency	Solo
1:50–2:05	K80 Technical Problem-Solving Journal (launch)	Solo, ongoing after

2:05-2:20	K85 Reflection on Learning Gaps	Solo
2:20-2:40	K86 Mock Client/Instructor Feedback Implementation + full stage close	Solo, then full-group close

- This is the close of the entire stage, not just this sub-session — give genuine time to it rather than rushing if earlier sub-sessions ran long.
- Close by having each participant name one specific hard skill from K56's self-assessment they're most committed to developing further, referencing their K60 development plan directly.
- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Eight (Soft Skills), which shifts focus from tools and technical output to interpersonal and self-management skills.